

A minefield for Harvard, inside court — and out

Early wins but Supreme Court is a different test

By Shelley Murphy and Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

In the early days of its fight against the Trump administration, Harvard University so far may have the courts on its side. But over the long run, does Harvard have time on its side? Legal observers predict the school will prevail in stopping or at least delaying for now some of the more severe punishments meted out by the White House.

►The State Department has told US consulates to resume processing visa applications for potential Harvard students. B1.

But as the legal battles drag out, and possibly work their way up to a firmly conservative Supreme Court, Harvard is at an increasing disadvantage, several pointed out.

The high court has given more leeway to presidential powers, particularly on national security issues the White House has cited to justify its latest impositions on Harvard.

Moreover, the battle of attrition could wear Harvard down on the financial front: The legal battles will be costly, and in the meantime, Harvard may lose students and scholars who can't wait around to see which side ultimately wins.

"I think the government wins every time," said Brad Banias, an immigration lawyer based in Charleston, S.C., and former trial attorney for the Justice Department. "If I'm an international student and I have a choice between Harvard, HARVARD, Page A14

Data centers: power play or energy drain?

Expansion to test limits of local electric markets

By Sabrina Shankman
GLOBE STAFF

Have you used AI today? Or, more likely: How many times have you used AI today?

Whether it's ChatGPT or a simple Google search, AI is getting faster, more pervasive, and harder to avoid. And all that comes with a cost. Data processing of this magnitude requires a staggering amount of electricity, at a time when households in Massachusetts are already reeling from high utility bills and the state is trying to wean itself off fossil fuels to combat climate change.

As Massachusetts prepares for an anticipated boom in new data centers — warehouse-size rooms with rows and rows of densely packed servers and cooling systems — the questions are piling up: Just where will all that electricity come from? Can Massachusetts add enough solar panels and wind turbines, or will it have to fall back on fossil fuels that DATA CENTERS, Page A17

An economy pressed from all sides

Region's business model especially exposed by Trump's policies

EDUCATION

Higher education is so pervasively part of the economy that any attacks on it could undermine business activity in countless ways.



MATTHEW CAVANAUGH FOR THE GLOBE

Like other schools, UMass Amherst could face change.

INFLATION

Businesses are pulling back as federal spending cuts, rising costs, and uncertainty over tariffs begin to take a toll on the economy.



FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE

The food industry relies heavily on immigrant labor.

ENERGY

Clean energy companies that help Mass. meet its climate goals and create new jobs face headwinds as Trump embraces fossil fuels.



GLOBE STAFF/FILE

The future of solar power remains unclear.

INNOVATION

The startup world thrives on a symbiotic relationship with higher ed and immigration, and would suffer as those sectors are under attack.



GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Robotics and other innovations may be at risk.

This story is by Larry Edelman, Hiawatha Bray, Alexa Gagosz, Diti Kohli, and Omar Mohammed of the Globe staff, and Globe correspondent Stella Tannenbaum.

From higher education to hospitals, from retail shops to tourist destinations, employers across the state are bracing for the fallout from President Trump's campaign to upend global trade, immigration, and "woke" universities.

Even before a single executive order was signed, many feared his agenda would hamstring a local economy built not on manufacturing might — the president's obsession — but on brainpower.

Four months into Trump 2.0, the reality is worse.

Massachusetts isn't just collateral damage; it's a primary target as the White House slashes funding essential to an ecosystem of education, health care, and life sciences that supports 1 in 5 jobs in the state.

Meanwhile, the ripple effects threaten to derail growth

in emerging tech sectors such as clean energy and robotics — industries the state has counted on to offset slower job growth elsewhere.

Trump's agenda has exposed how vulnerable even a dynamic regional economy is to punitive, ideologically driven federal policy.

"The reality is that the Commonwealth's business model is at risk," said Jeff Bussgang, general partner in Boston at venture firm Flybridge Capital.

After the November election, the concern was that Trump would overstimulate the economy — cutting taxes and deregulating aggressively, even at the risk of inflation. Tariff-driven price hikes are still on the table, but the bigger threat is a recession.

Why? The White House's erratic policymaking — particularly seesawing tariffs and threats of economic retaliation — has created deep uncertainty. MASSACHUSETTS, Page A12

Armed and blasé: Guns part of ordinary life in Western Mass.

Many say Beacon Hill doesn't get their culture

By Danny McDonald and Kirkland An
GLOBE STAFF

PERU, Mass. — By at least one metric, here is the gun capital of Massachusetts, a hamlet that shares its name with a South American nation and is home to about 800 residents nestled in the hill country of the Berkshires, just under three hours from downtown Boston.

The center of town consists of a few nondescript buildings along Route 143. There is a tiny library and an unremarkable-looking town office building that sometimes is unlocked even when

no one is there. As in many New England communities, there is a church painted white, and a patch of grass memorializing the town's war dead. There are no gas stations, convenience stores, restaurants, or bars. There is a single blinking traffic light in Peru's 26-miles-square.

But there are guns. Many guns. According to a Globe analysis, Peru has the highest per capita rate of licenses to carry in Massachusetts. Nearby Savoy, with a population of about 645 people, according to the 2020 Census, is No. 2. (The Globe GUNS, Page A16



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Gunsmith Bob Lamb, 71, worked on a rifle in his shop, B&W Firearms, in Cheshire.



Coco Gauff of the United States won the women's singles title at the French Open in Paris. C7.

The Tony Awards are tonight, and critic Don Aucoin has spotted a morbid recurring theme. N1.

Plans change quickly in Death Valley when the temps top 100 degrees; what doesn't change is the jaw-dropping, austere beauty of the biggest

US national park outside of Alaska. N13.

Russia pummeled Ukraine's second-largest city, Kharkiv, overnight, killing at least three people, local authorities said. A6.

Former governor Charlie Baker says he has no current political plans; his NCAA job is plenty. C1.

A bit better

Sunday: Less humid, some sun. High: 68-73. Low: 54-59.

Monday: Showers early. High: 60-65. Low: 53-58.

Complete report, A24.

Obituaries, A22.

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